

Relevance

- At an abstract level, IR is about:
 - does item ***d*** match query ***q***? ... or ...
 - is item ***d*** relevant to query ***q***?
- Relevance is a tricky notion
 - will the user like it / click on it?
 - will it help the user achieve a task? (satisfy information need)
 - is it novel (not redundant)?
- Relevance → similarity
 - i.e. ***d***, ***q*** share similar “meaning”
 - about the same topic / subject / issue